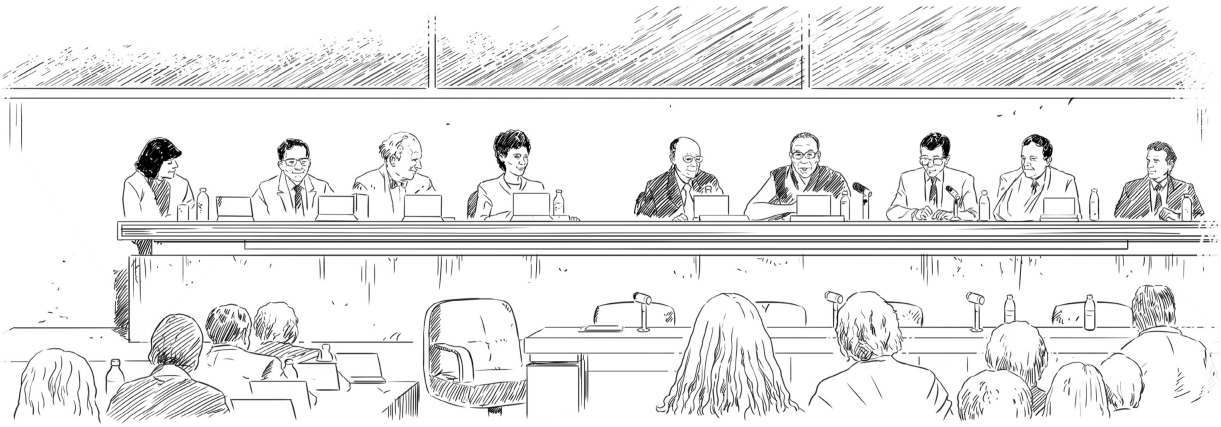
control of the Tibetan people. So the Dalai Lama refused to return. He realized he could do more for Tibet by staying in India. He could keep Tibet's traditions safe and strong by remaining free of Chinese control.

By the end of the 1980s, Tibetans in Tibet had grown angry with the Chinese. They started to fight back. Lhasa once again became a battle zone, just like it had thirty years earlier when the Dalai Lama escaped. The fighting lasted more than a year.



The Dalai Lama presents his Five-Point Peace Plan in the European Parliament

The Dalai Lama was not looking for more battles with the Chinese. So he traveled, speaking about peace and hoping the rest of the world would listen. "Our struggle must remain nonviolent and free of hatred," he said. In 1987 and 1988, he visited the United States and Europe to share his peace plan with foreign governments. This plan declared that Tibet should be a zone of peace and nonviolence. He wanted the Chinese to withdraw their soldiers. He wanted the rights of his people protected. He wanted Tibet's natural environment protected, too.The Dalai Lama's hope was to start conversations with Chinese leaders about their future together. He proposed that Tibet would be a province of China, but that Tibet would govern itself and be allowed to keep its own culture and religion. He wanted to create what he called The Middle Way—a compromise that would work for both Tibet and China.

But China wasn't willing to listen. They weren't interested in the Dalai Lama's plan. The Nobel Peace Prize committee, however, was very interested. In 1989, they awarded its international prize to His Holiness the Dalai Lama. The committee honored him with the award because of his compassion for the people of Tibet and his homeland. Instead of fighting